partnership that would co-develop and co-produce major defence platforms. Finally, there are indications that the US position on issues of key security concern to India is beginning to synchronise with that of India. For instance, during the Doklam crisis in 2017, the United States expressed its concern about China's violation of Bhutanese sovereignty and called for a "return to the status quo" through "a negotiated solution" that restores peace in the area.[111]

What this deepening security cooperation between India and America indicates is the possible emergence of an external balancing element in India's China policy. But would India forge an alliance with America? What form would such an alliance assume? Ultimately, as Glenn Snyder has highlighted, the crux of the alliance question lies in the extent to which each side is willing to make a military commitment to the other. Whether a state decides to make a stronger or weaker or no militant commitment to another depends on two factors: 1) the extent to which it shares with the potential ally interests that are in conflict with those of the adversary and 2) the extent of mutual military dependence with the potential ally.[112] With respect to shared interests: India does share with America an interest in promoting a rules-based liberal order. India also shares with America an interest in preventing Chinese hegemony in Asia, although it would ultimately prefer a multipolar Asia rather than reinforcing and perpetuating US primacy.[113] For its part, America views Arunachal Pradesh as an integral part of India, and its endorsement of the McMahon Line dates back to October 1962, but it has refrained from taking a position supportive of India's claim on Aksai Chin.[114] Moreover, it was lukewarm and indirect in its support during the Doklam crisis and may not fully support India on all territorial and security issues relating to China. All in all, while there may not be complete harmony of interests